

ANOTHER FRAGMENT OF THE STORY OF ALEXANDER.

By W. E. CRUM.

I had lately occasion to look through the Coptic "Fragments" in the collections of the British Museum, and was fortunate enough to come upon a sheet of paper (Or. 3367,) in good preservation, which adds some fifty lines to the texts published by M. Bouriant in the *Journal Asiatique*, (8^{ième} série, ix, p. 1 and x, p. 340,) and now in the Bibliothèque Nationale.

The newly found sheet is, in all respects, similar to those already known (*cf.* l.l., the *facsimile*). It clearly formed part of the book to which the others belonged, measuring as it does about 7 × 5 in., — the Paris sheets are 18 c. × 125 m., — and being written in a character identical with that of the other texts.

The dialect employed is Sahidic, yet characterised by a marked tendency towards Boheiric forms, both in orthography and punctuation, * as also in the formation of certain of the letters. Upon these points, however, it is needless to enlarge; they have already been dealt with by M. Bouriant.

The Paris fragments contain eight episodes, more or less complete and intelligible. According to the translation published by M. Maspero in the last edition of his "Contes populaires" (Paris, 1889,) their sequence is as follows:—

1. Adventures of Alexander in India. Mention is made of the Brahmans and of a certain Kalynos.
2. Alexander, disguised as a messenger, is detained at a foreign court and becomes acquainted with Eleazar, the Persian.
3. Alexander, supposed to be dead, is concealed by Antiochos.
(See below.)

* The mark used by the scribe above all letters is the same. It is, in truth, rather a dot than a line; a fact which, added to the mode of its employment in such words as ἐμμετε, ιοπερ, ἐνατ, ἐποϣ, is a farther indication of northern influence.

4. Menander's dream. Reception of the news of Alexander's death. (*See below.*)
5. Alexander, disguised as a soldier, overhears Agrikolaos, king of the Persians, congratulating the troops on their freedom from the Macedonian yoke. Then, discovering himself to his friends, he orders the execution of the Persian king, while he rewards and exalts Eleazar.* (*See below.*)
6. Antipater, exhorted to seek his father (? Alexander), declares him to be long since dead.
7. The plot of Antipater to poison Alexander.
8. The poisoning of Alexander.

Of these incidents, only the last two can be identified in the Greek romance of Pseudo-Callisthenes. The others belong to some unknown version. (*See P.S.*)

As our new-found fragment is concerned with farther adventures of the king and his three companions, Menander, Selpharios and Diatrophe, I will, before dealing with it, give a translation of those portions of the Paris texts in which these actors appear.

In passages of difficulty, where no other interpretation suggested itself, I have followed that of the former translators, indicating the sources respectively by the letters B. and M.

Journ. As., 8^{ième} série, ix, p. 14. (*v. Masp.*, "Contes," p. 326.)

(RECTO.)

"Alexander has died in the Chaosm (*sic*)." All that heard cried aloud, and the king, when he had heard (it), was grieved at heart and bewailed the kingdom with Antilochos. Said he, "I was anxious to despatch the great king into the Chaos (*sic*), and I (now) fear lest his army come upon us." Said Antilochos to him, "I was eager in begging thee to pardon him and thou hast not decided to take my advice nor hast thou turned thy face toward me." Said the king to him, "Why hast thou not found means to pardon him?" But at night, they brought Alexander to the house of Antilochos, and he took him and put him in a vault and supplied him with all

* The group $\overline{\text{NCEP}}\&\text{CEP}$, used here (Bouriant, l.l., ix, p. 10) to denote the manner of binding the captive women, appears to me to represent the Arabic سِلْسِلَة plur. سِلَاسِل *vinculum*. A genuine Egyptian word could not have such a vocalisation.

good things. Now the news was spread abroad in all the country that Alexander was dead; and all that heard it were as stones (ω?) what had happened.

After this Menander saw a dream in this wise, a vision, which he beheld in this fashion. A lion, bound with an iron (chain), and he saw him as he was cast down into a pit. And lo, a man talked with him, saying, "Menander, how is it that thou art not gone down with the lion? Dost thou not see that his purple is fallen? * he spoke in haste [? ⲉⲛ ⲟⲩⲃⲉⲡⲏ] with Selpharios and Diatrophe, saying, "Ye sleep?"

(VERSO.)

They said, "What has happened, oh, Protopilosophos?" (M.) Said he, weeping, "I shall shall befall the enemies of Alexander † the vision of those that hate him passing by in a dream. I was like to a stone, by reason of grief." Said Menander to them, "The lion which I saw was the king." They held converse till the morning, (when) lo, a messenger came to Selpharios, Menander and Diatrophe, crying out, weeping and saying, "Who will (? could) hear these words that I have heard and be silent? For (? though) the speaking of them is terror, and the bringing forth of them shame." ‡

Quoth Menander, "What is the word (you bring), my son? I no longer know what has befallen the king Alexander." Said the messenger to them, "Men it was, worthy of death, that laid hands upon my lord, the king, in Gedrosia and have slain him." Then Menander took his purple robe, and rent it, and Selpharios and Diatrophe (took) their cloaks and rent them and lamented, and it seemed to them as if the earth were moved (*lit.*, and they were as if

* Bouriant's completion of the gap is not quite satisfactory. ⲭⲉ may imply a verb before it. Perhaps the space might be filled thus: ⲁⲩⲱ ⲡⲩⲛ]ⲁⲩ [ⲁⲛ ⲭⲉ &c., or ⲙⲡⲉⲕⲛ]ⲁⲩ [ⲟⲛ ⲭⲉ &c. In any case, a negative ⲁⲛ is out of place with the preceding ⲙⲡⲉⲕ.

† B.'s ⲁⲛⲁⲩ can only stand here if there is also space for a following ⲉ.

‡ My translation here supposes ⲡⲩⲩ for ⲡⲉⲩ, and regards ⲭⲟⲟⲩ and ⲧⲁⲟⲟⲩ (= ⲧⲁⲩⲟⲟⲩ) as nominal infinitives with suffix, although the article is wanting. Of ⲭⲟⲟⲩ for ⲉⲭⲟⲟⲩ (B.) there is no instance in these texts.

the earth were moved). Said Diatrophe, "I will go and bring news of my lord." And he took with him a chiliarch (M.) and three soldiers, and went to Gedrosia. They heard the news, and learned everything and returned (B.) to the army. When Menander heard these things,* he saying,

l.l., p. 19. (*v. Masp.*, p. 330).

(RECTO.)

When evening was come, Alexander arrayed himself in a soldier's cloak, and went out, walking through the camp. Now Selpharios commanded in proclamation (B.) that no one should drink wine, nor put on † fine raiment for forty days of mourning for the king Alexander. But Alexander went his way and saw Agrikolaos, the king of the Persians, upbraiding (so B., but ?) his army and saying to them, "Arise now, ye men of courage, and eat and drink, since the yoke is fallen from you, namely Alexander, whom they have killed. What is it which is thus in your ? hearts, that ye be servants to Macedonia and Egypt?" Quoth Agrikolaos (*sic. lege* Alexander), "It shall not be to-day that thou eatest and drinkest, thou good man, of steadfast heart." And he arose and went to those of Macedonia, and said to them, "Why will ye not eat nor drink, seeing he that slew you in war is dead? Behold, now he is slain; be glad and rejoice!" They said to him, "Thou art mad;" and when they had said this, they set about casting stones at him Alexander remained (? concealed himself) till midnight, went to the house of Antiochos and mounted upon Chiron.

(VERSO.)

He went to the place where Menander was, for their (*sic*) eyes were heavy. He said to Menander and Selpharios and Diatrophe, "Ye are my strength." (? = It is on you that I rely.) Said Menander, "Thy voice it was that I heard." Said Diatrophe, "My father, what has happened to thee? It is an imagination that I heard." When they were silent, he repeated (his story), saying, "I am Alexander, whom the men of Gedrosia slew; but Antiochos preserved my life. Chiron, tell now ‡ what has befallen me." But when morning was come, he sat upon the throne of his kingship;

* B.'s restitution leaves no room for $\overline{\text{πστ}}$.

† B.'s $\overline{\text{πτερеч}}$ is not suitable. The gap would be filled by $\overline{\text{πпеч}}$.

‡ ? $\overline{\text{εποοχ}}$ for $\overline{\text{εποοχ}}$.

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VERSO.

- ρξ 1. ρερατ[εϥ ρ πεχε τ[εϥ]
 μη παϥ μ[μηνρσενσν]ατ χε ρω εροκ
 ω αλτξαντρο[ς μην]αντρος δε μπϥ
 οτωϥ εδρερατεϥ αϥβωϥετ δε ρα
 5. ποτερητε ημερτωωρ αϥπατ ερεποτ
^{sic}οειη πεχε αλτξαντρος χε μαρεπαμαρ
^{sic}τε ημιοειη^p ρεπωηε γαρ μμην^q ηε σελφα
 ριος δε αϥμμερτοτεϥ^r αϥαμαρτε ηϥτοοτ
 μενπααντρος τε ϥομμετ διατροφη τπατ
 10. αλτξαντρος δε ρωϥ αϥσοοττεη εβολ
 ητεϥβix ηρβοτρ αϥμαρρες αϥαμαρ
^{sic}τεϥοτπαμ
 τε ηϥομμετ ητετ^s ετεμματα α τεϥβix
 ηρβοτρ ρθε ητεϥοτπαμ ατω ϥϥαν
 βοκ^t εππολτμος χην εππατ ετεμματα
 15. ϥαϥμμεϥε ητεϥβix σεητε αλτξαν[τρος]
 τε^u αϥϥωλεμ εηποβ ησδιποτβ[ε^v τες]
 μη δε αςταρεμματα χε παλτξαντρος
^{sic}μμηνρϥομμετ^x ησοη χε ρω εροκ ωλεξαν

p. = ηιοτοειη.

q. = μμε.

r. = αϥμερτοτϥ.

s. = †οτ. [as if for * τεοτ.]

t. = βωκ.

u. = δέ.

v. = σ†ποτϥε.

x. = μερϥομπτ.

20. τρος ερϣαν περτο βηπ^γ επωτ ϣαϣ
 χωρεν πεϣρ^η ατω πεχε τεσσην οη χε
 αιδι^z υπετεκοταϣεϣ πεχε αλτξαν
 τρος χε αα παι πτεροτσια εχεν π
 καρ τερεϣ^{aa} ατω πτε παχαχε ρηποτας
 σε^{bb} παι πεχε τεσσην παϣ χε εβολχε α
 25. πεκαιδι ααοι ποτποβ παρε αλλα εις
 πκαρ τερεϣ^{cc} ακπατ εροϣ ρπ πεκβαλ[ατω]^{dd}
 ακερχοεις εροϣ αλλα ρϣαν π[ωπε]^{ee}
 [τι] εβολ απεφοτοειν τοτε

y. I am not clear as to the use of this verb. *cf.* Peyron, *s.v.*

z. = αἰτεῖν.

aa, cc. = τηρϣ.

bb. = ὑποτάσσειν.

dd. There is hardly room for ω.

ee. ω (or ϣ) partly visible.

(RECTO.)

He wondered the four rivers which flow forth from it, these being the Pison, Gihon, Tigris and the Euphrates. They drank water from them and were glad, because that spring of water was sweet. Afterwards they beheld a great Darkness and said, "We cannot enter (it)." Quoth Menander, "Let us bring some mares that have young,* and let us mount them, and let their young

* The Qualitative of αICE is very rare and its value here, to me at least, not clear. Since the verb is found as a transitive and an intransitive, its Qualitative may = "brought forth" and also "in the state of parentage" (*v.* Stern, § 348). The latter appears to be the meaning in Zoega, p. 38, l. 14 :

οτβαααλι εσσοσι εθρε πεσκοτχι αααα οτερ
 ησωα. In a newly acquired MS. in the British Museum (whose perusal was kindly allowed me by Dr. Budge), a passive sense seems suitable; ρεπαα
 εϣρϣωρ ατω εκκη εβολ ερε πεθρηον πρητοτ
 ατω ερε πβαϣορ αοσε πρητοτ.

ones * be kept without, and let us, for our part, penetrate into the Darkness." And (?) they wondered, for it was very dark, so that one would not see the other's face. Said Alexander, "Come with me, thou, Menander, and Selpharios and Diatrophe." They mounted on four mares that had young, but their young ones remained in the light, hearing each other's voice (*i.e.*, the parents and the foals); and they went into the Darkness. And they heard the voice saying, "Alexander and Menander and Selpharios and Diatrophe! Content yourselves (to have arrived) at this place!" Said Alexander, "I will not be content until I find that which I seek." And he advanced still a little farther and stood still Said the voice to him

(VÉRSO.)

for the second time (?), "Content thyself, oh, Alexander!" But Menander did not wish to stand still, and he looked below the feet of the horses and saw things shining. Said Alexander, "Let us take these shining things, for they are gems." And Selpharios filled his hand and took four, while Menander (took) three, Diatrophe two. But Alexander himself stretched out his left hand and filled it and took three (and) his right hand five of them. His left hand was as his right, and when he went to war, from that hour forth, he used to fight with his two hands. Now Alexander smelled a great smell of incense, and the voice caught the ear of Alexander for the third time, saying, "Let it suffice thee, oh, Alexander! If the horse should take to galloping (?), he will injure his body." And the voice said farther, "Ask what thou wilt." Said Alexander, "Give me power over the whole earth and let my enemies be in subjection to me." Said the voice to him, "Because thou hast not demanded of me great length of life; but lo, the whole earth, thou hast seen it with thine eyes and (?) hast ruled over it. But when the stone (?) yields up (?) its light, then"

* **ϣⲏⲣⲉ** here must refer to the foals. It is similarly used in (Boheir.) Levit. xxii, 28, with reference to cattle. The *νεανίσκος* or *παῖς* of the Bible are in Coptic rather **ⲉⲣⲣⲏⲣⲉ** : **ⲉⲗⲣⲏⲣⲓ** and **ⲉⲡⲉⲡⲉⲗ** : **ⲉⲗⲟⲩ** (*e.g.*, Acts v, 10, and Gen. xviii, 7); otherwise one might be tempted here to see a reference to attendants, "young men," and to translate **ⲉⲩⲙⲟⲥⲉ**, "young, (lately) born horses." Yet to this the 3rd pers., **ⲡⲉⲩⲙⲟⲥⲉ**, would be opposed.

P.S.—After writing the above, my attention was drawn by Dr. Budge to the Syriac version of the Alexander story, published by him ("Alexander the Great," 1889). The Discourse attributed to Jacob of Serugh contains an episode evidently of identical origin with that in our text as to the expedition into the "Darkness" (v. l.l., pp. lxxix, and 170 ff.) though the Syriac story is amplified by various details wanting in the Coptic text.

